The Stinky Cheese Man & Other Fairly Stupid Tales

By Jon Scieska

Suggested Roles

ACTOR 1: *Jack the Narrator; Little Old Man, Cow, Little Girl, Little Boy, Fox, Princess in the Frog Prince story, Little Man.*

ACTOR 2: *Ducklings, Townsman, Little Old Woman, Stinky Cheese Man, Frog, Little Red, Wolf, Queen, Princess from the Prince and the Bowling Ball story, Cinderella and the Giant*

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

JACK THE NARRATOR: Once upon a time there was a mother duck and a father duck who had seven baby ducklings. Six of them were regular-looking ducklings. *(Actor 2 portrays six quacks – one for each regular looking duckling)* The seventh was a really ugly duckling. *(Actor 2 portrays the ugly QUERK of a very ugly duckling)* Everyone used to say,

TOWNSMAN: What a nice-looking bunch of ducklings – all except that one. Boy he's really ugly.

JACK THE NARRATOR: The really ugly duckling heard these people, but he didn't care. He knew that one day he would probably grow up to be a swan and be bigger and look better than anything in the pond. . . Well, as it turned out, he was just a really ugly duckling. And he grew up to be just a really ugly duck. *[Actor 2 makes the ugliest duck face possible – QWERK!]* **The End**

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 1: *A long time ago, people used to tell magical stories of wonder and enchantment. Those stories were called Fairy Tales.*

ACTOR 2: *What we'll be presenting today are NOT fairy tales.*

ACTOR 1: *They are ALMOST Fairy Tales, but not quite.*

TOGETHER: *The Stinky Cheese Man and Other Fairly Stupid Tales by Jon Scieska*

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JACK THE NARRATOR: Once upon a time there was a little old woman and a little old man who lived together in a little old house. They were lonely. So, the little old lady decided to make a man out of stinky cheese. *(Actor 2 pantomimes the making of a Stinky Cheese Man)* She gave him a piece of bacon for a mouth and two olives for eyes and put him in the oven to cook. When she opened the oven to see if he was done, the smell knocked her back.

LITTLE OLD WOMAN: Phew! What is that terrible smell?"

JACK THE NARRATOR: The Stinky Cheese Man hopped *(Actor 2 hops)* out of the oven and ran out the door calling . . .

STINKY CHEESE MAN: *(while running)* Run run run as fast as you can. You can't catch me, I'm the Stinky Cheese Man!

LITTLE OLD MAN: *(sniffing the air and making a face)* I'm not really very hungry,

LITTLE OLD WOMAN: *(holding her nose)* I'm not really all that lonely.

JACK THE NARRATOR: So, they didn't chase the Stinky Cheese Man. The Stinky Cheese Man ran and ran until he met a cow eating grass in a field.

COW: *(chewing cud, abruptly stops and speaks with her mouth full)* Wow! What's that awful smell?

STINKY CHEESE MAN: *(hands on hips)* I've run away from a little old lady and a little old man and I can run away from you too, I can. *(while running)* Run run run as fast as you can. You can't catch me, I'm the Stinky Cheese Man!

COW: *(sniffing the air again)* I'll bet you could give someone two or three stomachaches, I think I'll just eat weeds. *(returns to eating)*

JACK THE NARRATOR: So the cow didn't chase the Stinky Cheese Man either. The Stinky Cheese Man ran and ran until he met some kids playing outside school.

LITTLE GIRL: *(waving her hand in front of her face)* Gross. What's that nasty smell?

STINKY CHEESE MAN: *(dancing around the children, maybe even farting in their general direction)* I've run away from a little old lady, and a little old man, and a cow, and I can run away from you too, I can. *(while running)* Run run run as fast as you can. You can't catch me, I'm the Stinky Cheese Man!

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LITTLE BOY: *(sniffing the air)* If we catch him, our teacher will probably make us eat him. Let's get out of here.

JACK THE NARRATOR: So, the kids didn't chase the Stinky Cheese Man either. By and by the Stinky Cheese Man came to a river with no bridge.

STINKY CHEESE MAN: How will I ever cross this river? It's too big to jump, and if I try to swim across I'll probably fall apart.

JACK THE NARRATOR: Just then the sly fox (who shows up in a lot of stories like these) poked his head out of the bushes.

FOX: Why, just hop on my back and I'll carry you across, Stinky Cheese Man.

STINKY CHEESE MAN: How do I know you won't eat me?

FOX: Trust me.

JACK THE NARRATOR: So the Stinky Cheese Man hoped on the fox's back. The fox swam to the middle of the river

FOX: *(coughing, gagging, sneezing)* Oh, man! What is that funky smell?

JACK THE NARRATOR: and the Stinky Cheese Man flew off his back and into the river where he fell apart. **The End**

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JACK THE NARRATOR: Once upon a time there was a frog. One day when he was sitting on his lily pad, he saw a beautiful princess sitting by the pond. He hopped *(Actor 2 hops)* in the water, swam *(Actor 2 swims)* over to her, and poked his head out of the weeds *(Actor 2 pokes head up and tongue darts out a couple of times).*

FROG: *(in a most sad and pathetic voice)* Pardon me, O beautiful princess, I wonder if you could help me.

JACK THE NARRATOR: The princess was about to jump up and run, but she felt sorry for the frog with the sad and pathetic voice.

PRINCESS: *(hesitantly)* What can I do to help you, little frog?

FROG: Well, I'm not really a frog, but a handsome prince who was turned into a frog by a wicked witch's spell. And the spell can only be broken by the kiss of a beautiful princess.

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JACK THE NARRATOR: The princess thought about this for a second *(thinking pose),* then lifted *(lifting)* the frog from the pond and kissed him *(kisses frog)*. *(Long pause while nothing happens)*

FROG: *(Laughing and jumping back into the water)* I was just kidding!

JACK THE NARRATOR: and the princess wiped *(wiping)* the frog slime off her lips. **The End**

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JACK THE NARRATOR: This next story is even better than the last three. See, it's about this girl who runs very fast and always wears red running shorts. That's where her name comes from, get it? So anyway, this girl is running to her granny's house when she meets a wolf. He tricks her into taking the long way while he takes the shortcut. Now this is the good part because Red runs so fast that she beats the wolf to granny's house. He knocks on the door *(knocks).* Red answers it. And guess what she says? *(in Little Red Voice)* "My, what slow feet you have." And that's it. The end. Is that great or what? So sit back, relax and enjoy – "Little Red Running Shorts. . . . *(Long pause; he gestures for actors to take the stage)* And now, like I already said – Little Red Running Shorts!

LITTLE RED: *(in a hateful and sarcastic voice)* You just told the whole story. We're not going to tell it again.

JACK THE NARRATOR: You can't say that. You have to start with 'Once upon a time'.

WOLF: *(also sarcastic and disgusted)* No way. You blew it.

JACK THE NARRATOR: *(To Little Red and Wolf)* But you guys are next. Look at the title *(gestures as if there is a large sign behind him)* – 'Little Red Running Shorts.' That's you.

LITTLE RED: Let's go, Wolf. We're out of here.

JACK THE NARRATOR: Wait. You can't do this. WAIT! **The End**

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JACK THE NARRATOR: Once upon a time there was a Prince. And this Prince's dad and mom (the King and Queen) somehow got it into their royal heads that no Princess would be good enough for their boy unless she could feel a pea through one hundred mattresses. So, it should come as no surprise that the Prince had a very hard time finding a Princess. Every

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time he met a nice girl, his mom and dad would pile one hundred mattresses on top of a pea and then invite her to sleep over. When the Princess came down for breakfast, the Queen would ask

QUEEN: How did you sleep, dear?

PRINCESS: *(politely)* Fine, thank you.

JACK THE NARRATOR: And the King would show her the door. Now this went on for three years. And of course nobody ever felt the pea under one hundred mattresses. Then one day the Prince met the girl of his dreams. He decided he better do something out about it. That night, before the Princess went to bed, the Prince slipped his bowling ball under the one hundred mattresses *(Actor 2 pantomimes this action)*. When the Princess came down for breakfast the next morning, the Queen asked,

QUEEN: How did you sleep, dear?

PRINCESS: This might sound odd, but I think you need another mattress. I felt like I was sleeping on a lump as big as a bowling ball.

JACK THE NARRATOR: The King and Queen were satisfied. The Prince and Princess were married. And everyone lived happily, though maybe not completely honestly, ever after.

The End

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JACK THE NARRATOR: Once upon a time there was a beautiful girl named Cinderella who lived with her wicked stepmother and two ugly stepsisters. These step-relatives were not only wicked and ugly --- they also made Cinderella clean the house every day *(Actor 2 pantomimes cleaning the floors).* One day the local prince announced that he was holding a fabulous ball at his castle. Everyone was invited. The stepmother and stepsisters got all dressed up to go. But, as usual, they made Cinderella clean the house, so she didn't have time to get ready. After the stepmother and stepsisters left for the ball, Cinderella sat down and began to cry *(Actor 2 Cries).* Just then a little man appeared.

LITTLE MAN: Please don't cry. I can help you spin straw into gold.

CINDERELLA: I don't think that will do me much good. I need a fancy dress, glass slippers, and

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a coach.

LITTLE MAN: Would you like to try to guess my name?

CINDERELLA: No, Not really.

LITTLE MAN: Come on, Do you think it's Chester? If you don't have a dress, it doesn't really matter. . . Oh, just guess a name, any name.

CINDERELLA: I'm not supposed to talk to strangers.

JACK THE NARRATOR: Then she closed the door and left the little man standing outside screaming.

LITTLE MAN: RUMPELSTILTSKIN! RUMPELSTILTSKIN! RUMPELSTILTSKIN!

JACK THE NARRATOR: When the stepmother and stepsisters got home from the ball, Cinderella told them about the strange little man. They still made her clean the house. And meaner still, they changed her name to Cinderumpelstiltskin. **The End**

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JACK THE NARRATOR: Now it's time for the best story – my story. Because once upon a time I traded our last cow for three magic beans and . . . hey, Giant. What are you doing down here? You're wrecking my whole story.

GIANT: I DON'T LIKE THAT STORY. YOU ALWAYS TRICK ME.

JACK THE NARRATOR: *(to Giant)* That's the best part.

GIANT: FEE FI FUM FORY. I HAVE MADE MY OWN STORY.

JACK THE NARRATOR: *(to Giant)* Great rhyme, Giant. And I'm sure your story is just as good. But there's no room for it. So why don't you climb back up the beanstalk. I'll be up in a few minutes to steal your gold and your singing harp.

GIANT: I'LL GRIND YOUR BONES TO MAKE MY BREAD.

JACK THE NARRATOR: *(to Giant)* I knew you'd understand.

GIANT: I WILL [TELL] MY STORY NOW . . . The End of the evil Stepmother said, "I'll HUFF and SNUFF and give you three wishes." The beast changed into seven dwarves happily ever after, for a spell had been cast by a Wicked Witch once upon a time.

JACK THE NARRATOR: That's your story? You've got to be kidding. That's not a Fairly Stupid

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Tale. That's an Incredibly Stupid Tale. That's an Unbelievably Stupid Tale. That is the Most Stupid Tale I Ever – awwwwk!" *(Giant grabs Jack; holds him tight in one fist . . . Jack hesitantly begins to tell his story)* Once upon a time there was a Giant.

GIANT: *(squeezing Jack tightly)* TELL ME A BETTER STORY OR I WILL GRIND YOUR BONES TO MAKE MY BREAD. AND WHEN YOUR STORY IS FINISHED, I WILL GRIND YOUR BONES TO MAKE MY BREAD ANYWAY! *(an ugly laugh)*

JACK THE NARRATOR: *(thinking aloud to audience)* He'll kill me if I do. He'll kill me if I don't. There's only one way to get out of this. . . *(clears his throat and beings the story)* Once upon a time there was a Giant.

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(sing softly and fade out to silence) This is the story that doesn't end . . . it just goes on and on my friends . . . Some people started *listening* not knowing what it was and they'll continue *listening* forever just because . . .] **The End**

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AWARD HISTORY

2003 National Qualifier
2004 National Qualifier
2005 National Qualifier
2008 National Qualifier
2011 National Qualifier
2024 National Qualifier

Melody for the ending song can be found here:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xz6OGVCdov8

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